

Robert Hartline is the Founder and CEO of CallProof, a company that helps B2B sales teams manage their customers using a sales activity reporting system. He has been a member of EO (Entrepreneurs' Organization) for about eight years. He is also a Professional EOS Implementer for EOS Worldwide, where he shares his experience using the EOS (Entrepreneurial Operating System) to scale a business from $10 million to $100 million in three years. Before CallProof and EOS Worldwide, Robert was the Founder of Absolute Wireless, a wireless retailer with 78 retail locations which he sold in 2020.

Colton Mulligan is the CEO and Principal Strategist at FoxFuel Creative, a creative agency that produces effective outcomes for brands through design, content, and technology. In his role, he drives strategy for developing and marketing brands and deploys new technologies to design innovative marketing campaigns and platforms. He has been a member of EO for about six years. Before FoxFuel Creative, Colton was the Account Supervisor and Director of Strategy at MMA Creative and the Digital Account Manager at South Central Media.

Eric Jackson is the Founder and CEO of Element 47, a web design and marketing agency that helps businesses reach their marketing goals and connect to their next customer. Eric has been a member of EO for about 15 years. Before Element 47, he was the Founder and Managing Partner at Keystone Business Solutions and the President of the EO Nashville Chapter.

Here's a glimpse of what you'll learn:

• Colton Mulligan shares how he became an EO (Entrepreneurs' Organization) forum sherpa
• The purpose of presentations in EO forums
• What is Biz, Balance, Buddies?
• Types of EO forum presentations
• Advice for facilitating an impactful EO forum
• Robert Hartline, Colton, and Eric Jackson talk about the 5%
• How to conduct an EO forum deep dive
• Colton explains the Feel Wheel and its role in deep dives
• Planned versus unplanned deep dive forums
• Tips for addressing various topics and supporting members during deep dives

In this episode…

Entrepreneurship is daunting and isolating at times. EO (Entrepreneurs' Organization) forums allow business owners to voice their struggles and make crucial personal and professional decisions. So, what makes an EO forum impactful, and how can you make the most out of the experience?

According to Colton Mulligan, there are two types of EO forums: deep dives and discussions. Deep dives are optimal for addressing the 5%, which are the aspects of an entrepreneur's life not shared with anyone else. Colton, Robert Hartline, and Eric Jackson have been

through rigorous forum training and understand how to optimize deep dives for maximum benefit. They affirm that a productive deep dive should lead to self-discovery, so it's crucial to implement tactics such as the Feel Wheel or the Biz, Balance, Buddies exercise to analyze and solve key issues in your personal and professional life.

In today's episode, Robert Hartline hosts Colton Mulligan of FoxFuel Creative and Eric Jackson of Element 47 to discuss facilitating effective EO forum deep dives. Together, they explain the purpose of presentations in EO forums, the Feel Wheel and its role in deep dives, and tips for addressing various topics and helping members during deep dives.

Resources mentioned in this episode:

• Robert Hartline on LinkedIn - https://www.linkedin.com/in/bobbyhartline/
• CallProof - https://callproof.com/
• EOS (Entrepreneurial Operating System) Worldwide - https://www.eosworldwide.com/
• EO (Entrepreneurs' Organization) Nashville Chapter - https://eonashville.com/
• Colton Mulligan on LinkedIn - https://www.linkedin.com/in/coltonmulligan/
• FoxFuel Creative - https://foxfuelcreative.com/
• Eric Jackson on LinkedIn - https://www.linkedin.com/in/ericpauljackson/
• Element 47 - https://element47.co/

Sponsor for this episode...

This episode is brought to you by EO Nashville.

The Entrepreneurs' Organization (EO) is a high-quality support network of nearly 15,000 like-minded leaders from over 60 countries.

EO helps transform entrepreneurs' lives through life-enhancing connections, shared experiences, and collaborative learning.

EO Nashville is the largest EO chapter in the US, third in the world, and has the most female members of any US chapter.

To learn more about how EO Nashville can benefit you, visit https://eonashville.com/.

Transcript

Introduction to EO forum

0:02 ·

Applause

welcome to the decision from Nashville EO where you will hear the rest of the story after tough decisions were made by entrepreneurs who faced adversity and live to tell about it

Music

0:23 · have you been in a situation where you're just stuck as an entrepreneur you're going to find yourself in a Crossroads a decision you need to make for your life or your business and many times that process is lonely and very tough to take that next action

0:45 · the decision is how we help in Nashville entrepreneur organization make that critical decision for you and your business or your life through experienced shares of other members inside form this is a three-part Series where we are going to work on how to give a great presentation how to not only coach but be coached in

1:13 · that presentation and last but not least how to be a great formate during that process of receiving a presentation inside form if you haven't checked out entrepreneur organization we'd love to have you come to event learn about how this organization has helped hundreds of fellow Nashville entrepreneurs grow their business through sharing best practices and

1:42 · experiences I am Robert Hartline along with Eric Jackson Colton Mulligan to cover some of the basics on how to give a great presentation now Eric how long have you been an EO um I joined in 2008 so about 15 years I think it's coming up on 15.

2:03 · I'm I'm right at eight and Colton what about you coming up on six one on six well when we started talking about as a chapter in our board about what does Nashville need it really came across that there is an added need for a place to talk about how to do a great

2:29 · presentation to really get good value of our form experience and every form is different they're kind of on their own little Island by themselves sometimes and you know it's been a long time since I've had form training and I know entrepreneur Opera organization has changed their style that they work with training forms and I'm just kind of rusty and so the purpose of the decision

The power of presentations

2:56 · our podcast is to not only Shine the Light on different things that have worked in the past with a presentation but what happened after the drama after that decision was made we're going to go back to these entrepreneurs and hear the full story the drama you know what happened and it's my hope to not

3:19 · just have a a normal everyday podcast where we're hearing about someone's founder story we want to hear the drama we want to have a searchable list of podcasts when you're dealing with your own drama and you're considering that next presentation you can go to a library of other experiences that kind of get primed and ready for that presentation or maybe even be inspired that there could be a decision and sometimes we make these decisions

3:51 · uh under a great deal of stress and those decisions just sometimes don't even happen we just go with indecision no decision and then let the situation make the decision so I thank you for guys joining here today um and uh as a as a eight-year you know

4:12 · I can call it maybe I'm a veteran I there's a lot I don't know about uh doing proper presentations but Colton you have some experience to share that you're going through some higher level of training than both Eric and I have have done can you talk to us about that um so shortly after I joined um I uh me and Ellie bird who is I would

4:37 · like to call her like the mother of EO I'm sure Others May think she is absolutely contention with that but she's been training Nashville for forever every new class of members come through Etc she's written so much curriculum that's got into it she and I just really geeked out after are training and I was planning our first Retreat and short story she said hey I'd

4:57 · love for you to be one of my Forum Sherpas so I went through her training certification process and then I mean literally right after my in my first year right after my first year I started going out and facilitating Retreats for other forums specifically about like dealing when there's you know conflict in the middle of a forum but also like Hey how do you get to the five percent and I've been doing this across EO YPO

5:19 · Harvard Business School Forum so everything that kind of takes the shape of what forum is I've spent a lot of time understanding her best practices that also come from EO and then going out into the field uh more or less and learning so much because I work with some forms that have been together 10 years some that are in their first year and so anyway that's some of the perspective I got you know my first training was really impactful for me I learned so much in that that full day session and it the lesson

5:49 · started in the first 10 seconds because one of my formates shows up after it had started he walks in you guys know where this is going oh yeah and she looked right at him and said um you need to leave and his eyes got real big he was like oh I'm being kicked out and that was a really good experience for our entire form because that set the stage how important it is to be on time

6:24 · you got to be on time inform is important there are people that are sometimes in a crisis and they need everyone to be attentive and for someone to be late and laissez about about being on time in attendance and it really set the stage for that that form of ours and we were on time and he was certainly on time for the rest of the time uh but um I certainly got red in the face and I was like oh that's not fun but the form

6:52 · training was for me was great are you talking about this because I was literally 90 seconds late yes yes yes yes absolutely all right we'll giddy up what do we want to dive into so for me um for me a lot of terms have changed and I think that's a good place for us to start um because tell me what terms have kind of changed when it when it comes to regarding presentations well first off

Defining the five percent

7:20 · why does EO have presentations in a form in the first place let's start from the basics um I think well I don't know I've never even looked into that specifically uh I I would gather from the overall value that's being offered is it gives someone the opportunity to explore a space with the audience of peers ex like they talk

7:41 · a lot now about self-discovery and then experience shares from others and presentations is I would argue like this little this weird format they figured out that does a great job of helping people get to deeper layers be transparent and vulnerable and and with that specific format then offering others the chance to come in and say hey here's the experience that resonates with me for shared learning and Discovery so I think that's why presentations exist Eric what do you think um in in my experience as we like to say it

8:14 · had to come out of it hell yeah um I I think the the act of creating the experience and even getting coached makes you discover the root of the real problem you know we go around thinking well this is what my problem might actually is but in many cases we've never really dug and deep enough to figure out what that actually is and

8:39 · through coaching through all that uh questioning in the presentation experience you begin to sometimes uncover things that really have a bigger impact on the decision you're going to need to make than you ever expected yeah and I think it's also important to realize that the presentation you know you know this is an entrepreneur organization so business owners right

9:03 · you would think that it's just all about the business and it's not all about the business there's so much um more that can happen in a presentation that has nothing to do with the business but everything to do with the business because our personal lives are so tied to that business and it's our energy that actually runs the company right but if our energy is being brought down because we have our own challenges with our personal life having a space where people can be authentic is

9:37 · critical right because uh it's lonely you know it's lonely running a company when payroll's on Friday it's lonely running a company when um you know your key competitors are stealing your people right and so where can you go to really vocalize

9:56 · a challenge you know we can go to our wives but and they're a lot of help right our spouses are a lot of help until they freak out yeah but but there's risk to sharing those stories with the spouse right because we don't want to stress them out and then and then we got more trouble yep as evidence of the fact of what you just referenced so at every Retreat I facilitate I have folks do Biz Buddy's balance have you guys done that oh explain gentlemen so every Retreat it's

Building trust at retreats

10:26 · a really great idea where uh Biz Buddy's balance three categories that you could look at what folks want to get out of forum and exactly to your point right most people before they join EO they think oh man I'm just so excited to have a business Forum where I'm going to be able to grow my business and don't get me wrong those are some of the benefits of it but bizbuddy's balance says that most folks want to get business which you get those kind of topics then you have buddies which is I just want friends that I can confide in and people

10:54 · I want to feel like I have my people right because as you as you age or honestly as your careers change right your friend group changes and then the middle thing is balance

which is all of what I would call the soft stuff that's the EQ and that's all this stuff that really centers on a sense of identity or or insecurity or uh my the roles I'm

11:14 · being asked to fill am I happy the all the like metaphysical questions in life that's what you're doing anyway everybody breaks down hey if you know 100 percentage points how what do you want to get out of forum this year rarely is any group's average more than 50 business but I've been in somewhere it's literally the lowest factor of the three wow and that that experience to

11:36 · getting those um I guess those interests vocalized in a form tends to happen typically faster at a retreat wouldn't you say man it's exactly I won I totally agree two it's why I tell every Group which this is this is like Colton Mulligan best friend I don't know that like EO would tell you it's best practice but I see so much growth happen the first time a forum gets together when you add a new member just do a simple overnight in the first 90 days because all of the even just the

12:06 · you know late night conversations and this the inside jokes but if you wind up doing a number of exercises that let you really get down into the five percent everyone gets so much more vulnerable and transparent earlier and they just the the value you get out of it is so much richer so much sooner exactly so

Deep dives vs. discussions

12:25 · let's let's talk about presentation in and of itself now um there's several types of presentations and can you walk us through what uh what's typical and then what's what's maybe not so typical first curveball if you look at any of the slides from like moderator trainings and stuff like that right now they don't even have the term presentations in there so I was about to say a thing changed yeah they were telling me I have to change the terms now yeah we need to

12:51 · scrap the first half of this podcast I'm going to be honest you're already perfect definitely exactly why we're doing that that's it so what's what is it now they now refer to them as they split them in terms of uh deep Dives and discussions largely uh is the way that they split it and to be clear I think

13:09 · part of the reason why they did it is a presentation right like when I say hey like imagine a presentation in your head what is it uh some guy's gonna talk for 45 minutes he's got slides behind him and he saves 10 minutes for Q a and that's obviously we know that's not the format right so I think that's why they did it and they're splitting that deep dive versus discussion so with deep dies

13:28 · that's really getting down to the five percent or one percent and that's typically EQ space uh which for those that don't know EQ your emotional quotient or emotional intelligence and then there's the IQ space which is the what and how of things so that's more like hey I'm trying to restructure my Organization for tax advantages or I need better hiring practices etc those

13:50 · are normally called discussions and under there is really where you have a a lot of depth of different things from like brainstorming debate um internal expert external export expert Etc versus what you have on that other side which are those deep Dives typically the more EQ oriented stuff so

14:08 · when you go and you say five percent yeah get to the five percent because some people may not know what that means love it yeah so on the bell curve of life I'm having to move around the microphone here so this is getting awkward but in the uh in the bell curve of life if uh if that total bell curve is 100 of your experiences that are known to others they say there's the five percent best and the five percent worst which is man uh the five percent

14:32 · worst makes sense for a lot of folks right it deals with insecurities problems in my marriage problems in my business uh in Discretions that I've had right I don't want to share those with anybody because most folks would say yeah you know 80 to 90 percent of your life you're comfortable sharing that people can see the middle of that is like oh things you know you know where I work you can Google it you can find it it's the other stuff outside of that and I'd also argue this I tell folks this

14:58 · like not to forget about that upper five percent which is the best stuff in life and to be honest you guys know this like commonly as entrepreneurs if you're the guy at the top who do you you can't go brag down to your employees there's nobody anymore that says hey good job man you really crushed it in that pitch Etc it's just you and my wife can only so many times be like okay I get it you're great at your job oh fantastic Colton right and so and I I have to tell my Forum that so I've got type 1 bipolar which means I've got my ups and downs and I honestly celebrate my UPS so much

15:30 · more because I know that a lot of my presentations during my downswings going into depression it's gonna be a lot of the five percent Downs so I always wore my form hey I'm going up I'm gonna be bragging on myself a lot and I'm glad I've got the space to do so ah that is great so any advice for those forms that

15:49 · kind of playing the BS game you know the they're present they're they're doing their updates and they're basically talking about the weather I mean they're not really digging in they're not digging in at all how do how do we break that because we we've all leave experience where you're not getting that level in some it's particular people tend to do this right they're not opening up how do you how do you make that happen two things one the moderator

16:15 · has an outsized impact on that right or whoever of the general it's the moderator isn't always the best like leader there but it's modeling what you want to see so if you and you guys have probably seen this and this is any group this is just social dynamics if one person is willing to get really transparent and open then the rest of the group can fall in line because what did you do you just set the boundaries for psychological safety oh my gosh honestly it's one of the reasons why I'll talk about bipolar pretty openly because it immediately

16:47 · like it lowers the bar very quickly for like how guarded I need to be because someone just went what they perceived to be real deep real quick right that's thing one then

the other thing is if you're doing really great clearing rounds with your Forum like I see this happen in a lot of Retreats where somebody straight I just had this happen

17:05 · in the last few weeks where somebody said hey I'm going to be honest I'm just making up names hey I'm gonna be honest Kevin you earned I don't feel like you're bringing your five percent and I want to see what the Forum needs to do differently is there something that's keeping you from the five percent are you in an odd spot in life but I want to know what's really going on with you and I feel like lately you've been a little surface level what about you um I remember that moment when I new EO member right just got put

Maintaining forum transparency

17:31 · in a forum with seven other guys we had an experienced moderator and and I don't remember what the topic was wouldn't share it if I did but somebody began to talk about something that was in the five percent and everybody was like oh this just got real you know they they revealed something that was very very personal very private

17:55 · uh I want to say there were some tears involved it was oh wow okay this is what I signed up for and it was impactful and it it impact you know everybody in that it's I still have five of those original eight in my Forum after 15 years everybody remembers those first few months we had an experienced moderator and uh we quickly realized that we could say things in that group that we couldn't say anywhere else

18:24 · I like this you know it it reminds me that um how important it is for um going deep and vulnerable in the beginning of a form experience of something they may be in my life that is not going great and and in encouraging that and reminding people when we don't hear the five percent we just have to ask and just be frank in it guys I I

18:53 · they're everything perfect are we really this perfect like surely something is not going right and I think the problem with it is it's just not a natural place for most people to be to sit down in a room with you know seven other strangers who've been trained right and they're not supposed

19:12 · to reveal any of this thing to the outside world can you really trust that that's gonna happen and so as Colton described going away for you know an overnight you know sharing a roof with these people for you know 48 24 48 Hours makes a difference you get to see how people actually are away from a forum meeting table and

19:35 · begin to understand each other on a deeper level for us it took a year to really dig in and and get it when we went on Retreat um but you know again my experience just took one person really diving into the deep end of the pool to let everybody else know that this is a different kind of experience you know it reminds me of uh our first Retreat when I joined we

20:00 · went on a retreat in Alabama it was the first time together we're all in a car and you know of any advice on the retreat if you can get in a car it's way better than a plane because you get everyone in the same vicinity and you're stuck for you know for us it was like four hours three and a half anyway we're in this car we drive down there um not eventful but we're coming back as a different driver now this driver

20:31 · like to go fast and like to be on his phone uh and like to talk at the same time and uh text and drive and call and and uh which created some massive stress in the car and which caused conflict uh we were uncomfortable and we vocalized it and that conflict was healthy because we got to see each other

20:57 · in a state that we had not seen each other prior because when you're together with a group of new people right you sugarcoat kind of a lot right you only show so much of your personality but seeing someone upset and angry and frustrated uh is very healthy and so if

21:14 · you can figure out a way to cause a little bit of tension sometimes that also helps uh but when we were talking about the five percent it's easy to talk about sometimes it seems to be in my experience easy to talk about a personal flaw or you know you're talking about bipolar right that's a five percent

21:32 · but another thing is my company may not be making any money and that's a that's kind of a embarrassing five percent because I I don't attribute them the same a personal fault in my business fault I treat differently right because you know you get kind of worried about what someone thinks of your business

21:54 · am I hitting hitting something for you yeah I think so I mean I think everybody has their own set of insecurities and some people are different I can talk about my business all day long but my identity I keep that very private so it's interesting I appreciate you sharing where you fall on that Spectrum um I uh to be I want to be very clear I

22:12 · feel like this podcast I don't have to respect Gestalt I am literally here for advice and experience shares on perspective I for some reason I still feel the need to get that out there let it fly all right there we go so um uh our Forum has a couple things baked in and I I honestly encourage all groups to do that in your first year put it all

Navigating coaching moments

22:32 · out there so everyone in our Forum knows everybody else's Revenue gross profit they know the salaries that they know the take home for every single person they know the salaries for most of the top Executives and whatnot we go through each other's tax returns when we're doing like tax planning and stuff like that we've got Bo Hanson in our group who's phenomenal at that and can save everybody probably close to six figures in your business in over a year or two so many anyway that's one of the

22:56 · things that's baked in like our uh it's part of our um I might even be part of our constitution but it's part of our regular rhythms where we're checking in on those figures so it kind of guarantees this thing it's very hard for someone to slip down into oh man business is getting tough and then they kind of back away from the table on that nah man we know when somebody you know like was in the red for three months you

23:17 · know um I encourage a lot of forums to do some version of that oh that's excellent advice so let's go right into the deep dive let's do it or otherwise known as the

presentation but that's the last time I'll put a little aspect around it but for my uh thinking and for people listening the Deep dive is

23:34 · sharing a Crossroads that you have something you have to make a decision and that's what this podcast is all about so can you walk through some different examples of what uh how a deep dive can look yes but can I be slightly contrary I mean that's why you had me on here so you can't you can't shake your head at this point we've met

23:55 · familiar um I would say that deep dies aren't just for the decision points in life they're amazing for that because those are commonly watershed moments right in my personal life in my professional life right but deep Dives are also really great to explore the unexplored in that

24:12 · Jahari window which we can get into but sometimes there is no decision right sometimes it's just I have been caring and insecurity my entire life I've been carrying a trauma I don't like the way that I view myself I don't like and so I'm saying this because it's the same thing where I have where I just want the space to explore something and hear experiences from others even though in the next five years I have no firm decision to make I just want to think

24:37 · about this or I want to change my perspective on something with no deadline in place does that make sense oh that makes perfect sense okay so with that I forgot what the hell the question was yeah well we've all we've all done that and had a deep dive and at the end of the day we did nothing and um and other than expose a a massive

25:00 · fault in some area that that we just don't have any Clarity on and and um and I mean I've had failed attempts at trying to get to the deep and never getting getting there and never making the decision and then faced with you know forced decision later because of an indecision prior right it was give me some examples of of that that's worked for either of you where you it it kind of EX you went into a deep dive you went

25:30 · through the coaching aspect and you do the presentation and then you discover you're not making a decision of the thing you were making a decision on it's it's something different this is my favorite so I'll give you examples uh and I'll I'll respect

25:47 · confidentiality fortunately I work with enough groups that it can meld all here's an example of one just uh especially for those that are new like in their first year or two and you're still discovering what it is I love these especially with like open coaching which maybe we should talk about to get into a a deep dive but

26:04 · um one time somebody was presenting on this element of like hiring practices I've got this I've got this major issue with turnover and culture and I don't know what to do and over the over coaching over over the coaching you know their stated thing was I want to have a deep dive on how should I uh change my

26:20 · interview process performance reviews and culture something like that by the end of it we're dealing with the fact that this person has so much identity wrapped up in their business they they are dealing with fears of rejection and trust that go all the way back to

some childhood experiences that are suddenly informing the active culture of their business and now we're having this whole discussion about in life how do you view reject intimacy and trust and suddenly

26:45 · that becomes the takeaway and nobody's passing around HR manuals to come up with better hiring problems that's beautiful and that's getting deep and that and that all influences how we how we run our businesses each and every day um it could be a past experience I had with my mom it could literally affect all of that I've lost track of the number of times I've gone into coaching and then come out with a completely different presentation you know that just the the act of

27:14 · speaking what's on my mind as I'm saying and I'm realizing oh this is not really what I want to present on at all it's something completely different and it can go to the to the personal as you've described an unbelievable uh uh example there of

27:29 · deep Dives and what they talk about now and I don't know if they used to push this term or not but the whole idea of self-discovery and group Discovery is is one of the tenets that they talk about when they're talking about deep Dives which helps everybody understand oh I'm not supposed to be giving this dude answers we are exploring a space together through shared experience and jumping into and I love when you hear somebody say what you're saying I guess this isn't about an HR methodology

27:55 · at all this is about the way I look at myself and the way I I find Value in the world like oh my gosh like how many places in the world do you have to go explore that it's not a lot I'm cousins my ratio of cussing is drastically more than else I'm holding back all right we're not keeping track all right you're doing just great because at the ultimately what we're trying to do is get to the meat of what

28:19 · a deep dive would mean to not only the form so there's some lessons from the formates because I learned just as much listening to someone's Deep dive about me that I do about my own presentation is just there's a lot of lessons because these are not unusual challenges like we

28:41 · have all faced uh some level of these of these challenges and just listening to these stories really helped mold our own businesses in many different ways when talking about the actual Deep dive how much of it is important to have some kind of deck or some slides or a handout

29:01 · how important is that into and why would you even have that in a deep dive I'd say there's a couple things if we're talking if the question is just like hey what resources are helpful so one tight timing helps so to go ahead and that should be baked in the agenda right so exactly how long are we doing open coaching or the presentation you know popcorn questions around the room questions experience shares reflection right so whatever that format

Tools for emotional depth

29:24 · is is great and then this is going to sound so so weird and there's so many I'll be honest there are so many things that previously I would have cringed at and then I hear something and then use it and I'm like this is so helpful so example how many have you guys seen the feel wheel yes okay you're gonna have to educate me the feel wheel is fantastic so the fuel wheel is something that um I have groups that laminate it and bring it to every single Forum with them because

29:52 · um what the fuel wheel does is it starts out its three concentric circles and in the middle you have eight basic emotions and it's everything from like it's like anger Happiness joy jealousy something something right and then the second Circle has four um of four more nuanced terms of the

30:10 · main one right so anger could also be frustration angst right it keeps breaking down then the third one has two or three per each of the prior right and the idea is um like there's the uh I think it's in Malcolm gladwell's blink there's a book where they talk about it which is um whether it's language emotion anything understanding the term that describes the thing like the example in blink is about wine and uh and um

30:37 · what's the name of the sauvignon blanc no uh what's the the the the professional expert on wine sommelier good gravy you could tell I don't belong in EO uh those folks they said that so much of it is understanding the term terms that describe wine and then you understand the Nuance it's the exact same thing with feelings for folks that aren't used to that space being forced and I've seen groups where they won't let you use any you can't use any of the boring eight emotions you have to

31:05 · use the further that's what the fuel wheel is for is when you go to do it get into the Nuance because that brings a greater level of understanding more so than just well I'm either angry or happy and that's all I got buddy uh so basic so basic so any tips like this that you

31:21 · hear in our podcast we're going to be in the show notes as a PDF attachment so whether it's a YouTube channel or Spotify there'll be some show notes for the feel wheel that's a great that's a great uh lead way into really talking about feelings about what someone is pres presenting and so so many times we're like oh it's it's a a b or decision it's not a a b or decision not uh it's not yes or no or door a door B

31:49 · it's it's has a lot more meaning behind that where where does that feel wheel show up in past Eep Dives that you've seen um so there's the five percent reflection uh sheet which you may know as the monthly update that that turns

32:05 · out so it's not monthly update not monthly update that's out okay that's gone what is it called again uh a five percent reflection you want to know the why on that yes go for it here's the why the why is monthly update leads to those shallow conversations that you're talking about um the shallow deep the shallow dive uh the shallow skim versus the Deep dive tmtm tmtm Colton just came up with the shallow skin versus the Deep dive that's mine uh so TM TM TM TM uh so uh here's

32:35 · the here's the concept behind that um the monthly update people would go uh okay my kid um so my kid had soccer practice uh the thing and he broke his leg and that that was you know that was traumatic for him and then we did um maybe I shouldn't choose breaking a leg maybe that is in your five percent sorry I'm new to having a kid I got a seven month old what do I know so uh but monthly update sounds like what it is right oh update me on what's gone on in your life five percent reflection is the opposite

33:03 · of that it's not oh let me just update you but let me take an hour or at least 30 minutes way you know a day or two before Forum to reflect on on what has happened this month in the five percent of my life and sometimes it's not even an event which an update seems to be like an event I had to fire my number two or I got a bigger tax bill than I

33:25 · expected right a five percent reflection which is what I love and somebody dropped this at a moderator Summit recently it's uh and I've written it into our five percent updates um what is a question you're pondering that is a great five percent update no event happened but for some reason there's this question that keeps coming around in my mind and it deals with my

33:46 · theology or my place in the universe my value my identity you know what like that's the stuff that's great so that's the term difference between a five percent reflection and a monthly update wow now do you see a lot of forms because I had a moderator one time really Force us to have our

Planned and impromptu sessions

34:05 · five percent reflections at uh brought to the form meeting not doing at you know many formates would write down their five percent they're like literally you know just before it's starting they're having their coffee and they're like ah you know it's kind of like doing your last minute homework yeah we shame those people in our Forum

34:26 · yeah as well you should well so ours is punitive uh we have the thing where we go around as part of the hey confidentiality uh you know confidentiality technology you go through you know technology off all that stuff show your five percent reflection if it's not filled out 100 bucks to the treasurer wow 100 bucks show up man that

34:44 · really makes a difference those little fines what are the fines are you doing Colton you're one minute late uh you if you're one minute late you have to split the bill that night with the group and we go get drinks and dinner you're not gonna believe it I'm a medium to heavy drinker so the tab is normally you know sufficient it's sufficient so if you

35:05 · show up if you're late you got to put your credit card in along with everybody else's and you pick up half the bill so that's right that nasty drink that you love so much Negroni yeah which I got from another EO guy a ringer I love that dude so much but uh he's out in it's uh peach Patel uh out in OKC but anyway man I love negronis um yeah the uh but I find that the more time that I spend preparing for my five

35:33 · percent reflection it's gonna be hard to get used to that uh the better the better it is and the emotion wheel also we're in on our update form we're asked to pick three

emotions that this update we're about to give how does that make us feel so that that can kind of get the attention of the others in the group oh you're feeling aroused and dismayed and

36:01 · aggressive what in the world can you go ahead and read the uh can you read the details on what that was that left you aroused and displayed I was just I was just randomly picking your senior five percent reflection right there I'm looking at it oh my gosh yeah all right well awful we're going to take a photo of that that'll be up on that'll be on the show I mean every form is different

36:24 · his experience is amazing apparently that a whole new level of form experience but they they say You're supposed to make EO your own right yeah yeah it's part of it yeah I mean there's nothing that keeps us from being aroused

36:39 · um Eric's contribution of the podcast thus far is outweighing US tenfold so here's a question that I have so uh and in many deep Dives um those are planned you know you have some time and space between you're going to do a deep dive and usually you decide on a deep dive at a form meeting well in

37:00 · advance so you have usually some time right oh yet again Cole I'm just Johnny contrary that's all I'm here for so deep Dives are great and commonly they can be planned but we do deep Dives so our

37:16 · agenda is one planned presentation which is typically a deep dive and then two or three impromptues all in a four-hour period and some of those are are deep Dives as well they may not take an hour but that concept you know deep Dives being largely relegated to EQ elements so if there's an issue that comes up high importance High urgency from a five

37:38 · percent reflection at the top of the meeting we'll do a deep dive at the end that's totally unplanned so I'd normally another way I split the way we talk about um presentation I just did it myself deep Dives or discussions is planned and unplanned that's really interesting because most most forms I've been in it's typically been one or maybe two uh but very planned and sometimes very long right but now now this kind of adds

38:06 · a Nuance so you can do a planned or unplanned Deep dive when it's necessary which it happens right yep and those who are uh have been around EO for a while you're probably familiar with the parking lot which is a list of these

38:24 · are the things that we've heard that from your five percent reflection that could be a longer presentation deep dive it's gonna happen let's go ahead and say we're going to take the swear jar off the table for now so you old folks out there that have been around EO for a long time uh yeah you you've got your parking lot from your update that is a

38:50 · potential some of those things that get written down that stand out the secretary in our Forum actually writes those down hey I heard that you're struggling with this that might make a good presentation for you and as Colton has so aptly described you may do it right then and there at an impromptu Deep dive which is also something new because you know I

think the way you were trained the way I was certainly trained it was it was an event we were not just doing it on the fly it was

39:20 · something that you prepared for you got coached for but maybe Colton you can explain a little more why you would want to do that impromptu are you guys doing impromptues or unplanned in your forms we're not taking advantage of it it's right we have got some cool yeah uh man there is

39:38 · so much value to be gained in there now granted there's another skill set that goes along with it um and there's some there's some templates and things like that that you can follow there's a coach's worksheet which still works even for the impromptu um but uh man like I mean YPO for example did away with planned presentations I'm pretty sure at least as of this podcast uh I believe they had

39:59 · um and if you want to talk about some of the benefits there one I would argue also if you can get in more presentations you know like EOS recommending you have at least eight members if you think about that you're only doing one presentation that means in a typical year most folks are only going to get the floor of the Forum one time you know what I mean and there's a lot of five percent things that come up the benefit of doing those uh the the benefit of doing some of the unplanned presentations rests on that whole balance of uh important and Urgent and

40:29 · so while you don't want urgent things to to overtake what you know all the content and Forum there's a lot of times where stuff comes up where both those things are high and you guys have seen it how many times like okay all right well I'm supposed to present in December and right now I have a topic ID and by the time December gets here and I did all the work on it's like it kind of resolved itself yeah yeah you know time all the time so that's the largely the value and the purpose in in doing a lot of unplanned I think but the you know certainly the the biggest Plus for the plan is typically a plan when it's going

41:00 · to be coached and that's where you're going to get the most value of everyone's time uh unplanned you know is unplanned and it's it can be all over the place and you really it's if it's uh unplanned Hot Topic that is really important it may be best for that parking lot uh to have some space because the coaching is tremendous value so here's a question wildest

Supporting members in crisis

41:28 · deep dive you have a story from ourselves or it could be from yourself or you've heard a story of of something and it doesn't have to be like wild per se um you know for me I had an experience when um things were falling apart for me and uh I was in a situation where I had a chain of Wireless stores it was Sprint stores and and T-Mobile acquired us and

41:57 · they had a shutdown 12 locations and you know there was no real outcome of the presentation other than giving me the ability to whine and Pitch about my situation right but it felt good that I could talk you know I could just share it and there wasn't anything that anyone

42:20 · had experienced really in in my form that really uh could bring any level of experience but just being able to have someone to talk to and let my fears be known right because my team was already frightened and so I couldn't really vocalize those fears with them as much as I'd like to um anything like that for you guys oh yeah I mean I have so one so this is uh so this is de-identified but I've worked with hundreds of EO members YPO

42:52 · Harvard Business School Forums all that stuff over many you know four years now so just dropping some stuff dude I've been in forums and it's uh I haven't told anybody yet but I've got a I've got a drug problem I've been on oxy since uh you know first six months now and I haven't told anybody and I'm trying to figure out what to do is it rehab tell my wife try and do it all secretly yada yada I mean everything from Affairs to my dad died five days ago and I still haven't told anybody because my relationship with him is very complicated uh I mean I've heard you run

43:24 · the gamut of of what it is everything for I mean there's a couple of of things that are like that stuff hits the fan and it's okay you know some things that borderline turned into an intervention because of relationships with alcohol and things people said to each other I mean uh there is Coke and hookers we could talk about the whole thing uh I have heard seen it and then had the Fate

43:46 · like at this point now nothing nothing really phases you uh and it's just I love how transparent people are and trust that group so sorry I I didn't mean to I'm still stuck at Coke and hookers right now we haven't had that yet and and I know one day maybe we'll get it and get to enjoy that that experience share for sure uh but but it really kind of uh does Shine the Light what could happen you know someone that is that is in a in

44:15 · a in a state where they are realizing they have an addiction you know really what is the what how does a form deal with that level because you know those types of things kind of need a little bit of follow-up maybe maybe um for me you know the one that pops into my mind was I want to say December of last year my dad almost died uh uh

44:46 · you know going through the whole ICU dance understanding very quickly that nobody was talking to each other and you know he's not getting the carry he's supposed to be getting for me my my presentation my deep dive was around all the emotion

45:03 · that I felt I got pretty red-faced uh I dumped on the Health Care system that we have which is a dumpster fire if you ask me but um it it was it was a it was a way for me to at least feel a little bit of uh uh get a little empathy you know I just I was walking around in a rageful

45:26 · um attitude hurt you know thinking that my dad was gonna die uh that that there were mistakes made and and so it was just nice to be heard you know and it and and um I don't think anything really got resolved I got a little bit of feedback and and that presentation but

45:48 · um you know sometimes you just gotta let the crazy out Aaron Jackson sometimes you gotta let the crazy out I like the place for it yeah you need shirts that would be a great shirt for EO to have let the crazy out who let the crazy out why should we

Personal growth and purpose

46:04 · let the crate because we are a little bit weird all of us you know we're all I what is what is the percentages of people that are bipolar as entrepreneurs in like 50 or something I mean it's oh that'd be crazy I I know that um uh there was a Swedish study uh done on this but uh so both bipolar and mental

46:23 · illness among uh artist creatives and also entrepreneurs it's it's uh like twice the average of like your standard population so that's it's not 50 but you know I I wouldn't be surprised if it was as high as five ten percent yeah and and

46:39 · that statement you know sometimes I because I feel we are just different you know because we when you create something out of nothing right uh you have to have a certain level of being bold and kind of being putting yourself out there to to a certain extent and so

46:59 · for a lot of people like um we have to be brave and we have to get outside our comfort zone and sometimes in our heads we think am I crazy you know you kind of wonder that yeah well there are times where you just can't really talk to people about what's going on in your business and you got to be careful about what you say to certain certain individuals um sometimes you just want to blurt these things out but you know you can't because you can damage your culture you can damage relationships with your employees your spouse

47:31 · um yeah it's just a and sometimes I'll just randomly call my Forum mates just outside of forum and just go hey man I I've got something to want to talk about can I get this off my chest it's a beautiful place to be Robert can we go back to something sure one I appreciate

47:50 · that and I love the connection in between forums to make sure that like those individual bonds are very tight it's huge and I don't think enough forums like talk about that so anyway I've been guilty of that you know six months go by and the only time I see my forum is either add a Neo event or you know uh at Forum so anyway um the uh you would ask all right so what do you do in those scenarios right which I would argue if you're in EO for

48:14 · 30 40 years and you have lots of different members this would come up substance abuse alcohol abuse stuff like that and you said like well what do you do that that requires a follow-up Etc one thing so when those presentations happen and this is kind of across the board anytime someone's dealing with that the question that I hope gets asked at some point is how can the Forum support you right and

48:34 · and that can run the spectrum of like hey real quick you know when this is over and we walk out of this room how can we support you are you asking for check-ins are you asking for accountability do you need resources what is it and I need to be clear because every Forum has their own culture and I know some groups that are like dude I don't want I didn't join an accountability group I've got my small group at church or this that or the other

but still balancing whatever that looks like in your own personal ethos and what that looks like I think is really important but it's also it's it's fun it's crucial to make sure that you

49:06 · respect that that confidentiality and also that judgment-free zone because if someone drops something like that and then they make the wrong call on reporting them to somebody or getting their family members involved you know what I mean that you think you're doing in the best interest of that person you were running a real risk there and I'll be honest most of the people that I all of in my

49:29 · experience everyone that talks about having a substance abuse problem but says I'm no I don't need rehab or I'm not ready to go or whatever trying to go around them to help them get help and you're going to lose a lot of trust that way um yeah my wife mentioned something to me uh the other day that uh was discussed in forum and I and

49:53 · did you know about this I'm like what you know I don't want to discuss it I'm sure that it was okay to to share it but I just in my default is I don't talk to anybody else about what what is said

50:09 · in form and that's kind of the standard right but there are times where things are shared and you can share those you just got to be really really specific with the rest of your form and it's great to ask so and then like a segue away from drug and alcohol and mental health but also like we will ask that commonly at the end of ours hey real quick you're really celebrating this news here right right is this real quick is this and then it's great so folks go oh yeah yeah this entire presentation is

50:34 · fine I'm I'm really happy about and excited well you know you kind of bring up something that's kind of interesting when you're talking about drug and alcohol abuse is is getting the person doing the Deep dive getting other members of The Forum to ask deeper questions because it shows up in different ways for everyone uh some addiction or whatever but you know it affects everything you no what you what

50:58 · could be could be happening is the company could be falling apart his wife is leaving him is you know this is happening and that's happening and he's bankrupt right there's you you got to really go all the way deep because there's a lot of components uh to that and um you know how would you

51:18 · navigate that if you're in a form like that and you are concerned about a member like what would you do in terms of um helping like what what's what's an Avenue do you get other people in EO and and keep names

51:35 · out of it and have conversations to ask for some advice uh on how to navigate that because I could see that happening for a lot of form yeah I mean I I definitely think it's appropriate you know you care about these individuals I definitely think it's appropriate to go look for resources keep things anonymized if you can go to places hey I have a friend or there's someone in my life Etc I think that's healthy I also think just honoring the transparency in honoring the transparency that's baked into forum is also great just by sharing

52:01 · that with that person or you know all these folks that have high empathy reaching out to that person afterwards and saying hey man I know we did that presentation stuff like that I just needed you to hear man I love you I care about you and I have concern about you right now and I and I want what's best from you how can I support Etc because I'm going to be honest having somebody committed doing things against someone's will that's not ready pushing them beyond what they're ready to admit go into rarely works well and I just had

52:27 · this conversation the other day with somebody else uh calling up to ask about it being there for the person when they are ready to answer that to ready to ask the question is key no one has I don't I've never heard of a case where someone forces an intervention and it's tremendously successful however walking

52:47 · with someone checking in on folks I think is very appropriate so when they have something in life where someone a loved one says something to them but elsewhere they have a near-death experience and then they finally say man I've got to do something what should I do you being the person that's close enough to them and has maintained that relationship is really your best opportunity to help that person get on a better path I think now granted I am not

53:12 · a licensed therapist and nobody sue me or anything and you got to deal with consequences here on both sides but that that's the stance that I've taken in life yeah yeah I've had people uh reach out to me and you know say hey I'm here for you well all right while we're on the phone let's talk about this it it does work just knowing you've got that that that ear at any time is uh it's a it's a big lift

53:40 · there's been a few people and this is inside and outside of forum and yo but I've had folks where they've literally ditched the rest of their like the their families turned their back on I've gotten that call all of my friends all my family have turned my back on me right because either they think oh it's just another cry for help or this has been going on for years now and being close with that person also has its own elements right like I've got an individual in my life outside of EO and it's me and one other person they're still in this person's life everybody else had largely abandoned them but I

54:09 · even with my therapist had to work on what the boundary is there because how much which is also a key part of EO how much of your burden can I take on and set expectations for you that's unfair and so how do I operate in this space and I've cried to my therapist about this person saying I've got to make these decisions I can't every time I can't welcome you into my house and do this or that like at what point are you taking advantage and at what point am I enabling and then having to deal with the very weird headspace of if this

54:39 · person died eyes am I okay with the decisions I've made on how I'm I am walking alongside this person which is some heavy stuff yes dude very heavy if I get that call am I going to be going why didn't I text him why didn't I text him this week you know what I mean um anyway I didn't mean to get real dark real quick but if you're in a space where people are talking about the five percent and exactly what you're saying how do you show up those are really important questions to wrestle with and then figure out how do you you know how do you settle that with yourself yeah and you know the reality is is

55:11 · entrepreneurship is very difficult in and of itself but when you're also depressed yeah it's nearly impossible it's tough to navigate it's tough to show up with your own team with energy when one is depressed right and you know finding an

55:30 · outlet um uh in a form experience can be very helpful um even just to find somebody to go on walks with to find someone who um who has been down that very same Journey because we all have had some pretty incredible love um that um that need to be shared you know and sometimes it maybe doesn't even feel right to share in your form but one-on-one getting someone uh where you

55:59 · can say hey there's some you think that's bad why did you hear this story right and uh when you tell it they're like oh okay it's like if you go to any of these uh I hear these stories all the time um my father-in-law um he went through with some depression and um he was uh in one of these uh

56:22 · meetings with with other people that were also depressed and he's in this he's in this room with this man who cut off his arm because he was so depressed and that and and you know here here he is with you know a stub for uh an arm and here he

56:42 · and he's he's he comes out of that experience like huh I got both arms I'm good yeah you know and he just like changed his level of viewing his own personal situation was which was there was nothing going wrong he would just retired right and we all had go through that situation where you sell a business or a major life change like a divorce or

57:08 · um it could be kids living away going to school like there's a thousand reasons that you could find yourself where I'm I'm depressed how am I depressed right you just described uh the reason why what has become some of the most uh common curriculum that I wind up doing when facilitating Retreats with people is defining their values and then their purpose and meaning in life I can't tell you how many times I'm at a retreat and

Vision and legacy planning

57:39 · there's uh you know guys or gals in their 50s or 60s they've exited their business they've had a great family life and now I have I have a number of analogies that we've had to use that I've picked up along the way I lost my jet pack I can't find my next dragon to slay I don't know the next mountain to climb like you know all these things and it is unbelievable to see someone that

58:00 · has had so much success by most metrics that you could and so many individuals get to that point and they didn't take some time along the way to look at what they value where they find their own identity and meaning in life and then when so much of that stuff exits and they got a big bank account good gravy do they go through some tough times mentally yes and this would make a good forum uh exercise right I've defined

58:25 · mine I don't know about you guys mine is to connect and grow people and that's a part of my company's purpose but it's you know now I know what I want to do in the company I know what I want to do outside the company and so some big and I mean I just

you know if I had a big exit sure things would change but my core purpose would would not change yeah you know I I discovered this same thing uh when I sold my business

58:54 · um I went through some depression that whole year after selling the business it felt just like the divorce I had in 2001 identical the exact same feeling and it wasn't until I sat with a counselor who who walked through this book called The Three marriages we have a relationship with ourself with our spouse and her purpose lose any of those things and you're gonna have that sense of loss anger frustration all those things and in a form is a great place to

59:25 · begin to share those things I love the idea of defining what our purpose is with our formates uh because that's also a good question when it comes to when they're sharing a place in their life or decision they need to make and I know your purpose and I can point out well you said last you know you said the beginning of year this is your purpose now is this still your purpose are you still on this direction and it's okay to change your purpose right yeah but how nice is it to

59:54 · have someone to kind of call you up and say all right what is it make some decisions here and if you're gonna change that's great but let's let's all work through this together because those are the things that we're wanting out of that five percent reflection to come up and so that recognition of us off track and that's why it's so beautiful about having other form mates that hey

1:00:21 · off track let's let's get back in where we need to be because I can see you're off track I want to be called out as a as a a member of form I who else calls us out nobody nobody's calling us out in our companies right rarely is anybody you know they're telling us what we want to hear this is why I love the values meaning

1:00:44 · and vision exercise I mean it takes four to six hours to do it right yes but forums that do this on Retreat together where you wind up at the end of that Retreat is that you've done this exercise together to define the values for everybody my personal thing is no one deserves to feel alone and that's kind of my mission is I which I would go down that whole separate thing but if

1:01:05 · you do this uh if you do the values meaning and then vision for Life folks Come Away with this snapshot where each individual's had a chance to share with the rest of the group right now across eight dimensions of my life my business finances personal spiritual social Etc how do I feel on a scale of one to ten

1:01:21 · and everybody is up front with this giant white sheet of paper and they have notes on this and in a eight ten minute window they've all gone away and done some exercise they come back and they present to everybody here's how here's how I feel about life right now that's thing one so you kind of have a snapshot so oh I love doing this exercise you see me getting excited this is why I love it and I gotta do it like 50 of the Retreats then the other one one at the

1:01:44 · very end you I I have them do I'm not gonna I'm not gonna reveal I'm gonna leave some Prestige for it but there's a vehicle you get to planning five years in the future

and you talk about what that life is like so everybody leaves the retreat knowing what you look like right now and then what has to happen between now and five years from now which gives you that sense of even if

1:02:05 · people don't want accountability I still want to know what is driving you what do you really want to do in life and then whether or not it's accountability or just friendship and knowing to check in on stuff just inside or outside of forum oh such a valuable tool dude

1:02:21 · I'm absolutely doing this on our next Retreat because many of the formates they don't have any Vision no and it's the first time in their life anybody said what are you doing because a lot of us are just in the in the wheel we run into their wheel and we're running and running and running and then we're looking around and like oh my god I've done this for 20 years where am I going nowhere and gosh vision and knowing everyone's

1:02:48 · Vision too because a lot of those visions that we have is what we want to do actually align with other people in our form going through the exact same journey and if I know there's another format going on that same path that that's another connection point it's another thing in that five percent I'm listening for when we're doing those five percent I should be hearing that Vision appear

1:03:13 · when they start sharing and if I don't I think it's safe for us to go all right remember we did that thing and then Retreat that two years ago you said I have Rhoda here it's written down right where are you here and it really kind of

1:03:28 · forces but because we all get off track there's always something right you have the best intentions on Monday and then Julie quits right and then and then you never go there and you forget what you did in that Retreat so that reminder is is huge did I throw another exercise at you let's do it have you heard of Ika guy so uh it's the it's the Japanese concept

1:03:50 · for uh purpose or meaning in life right and I'll be honest I've tried to turn this into an exercise and because it's it's Japanese and it's like Eastern philosophy it doesn't land as well in Western culture especially with entrepreneurs that are like no give me a list where's the goals Give me the give me the kpis and write all the all the stuff uh here's what I love though it draws um and I'm doing this right now with all the forums Sherpa in January we're going to present all of ours to our each other because we get together and talk yeah yeah but there's a worksheet and uh Ika guy has a Venn

1:04:19 · diagram with four overlapping circles and it's what I can get paid for but I'm good at what the world needs and oh my gosh I'm forgetting the fourth what I'm good at oh what I'm what I'm good at what I enjoy that's it what I'm good at what I enjoy which are not always the same thing what I can get paid for and what the world needs there's a whole series of exercises where you can go through and fill that out and ichagai means finding as many

1:04:48 · things find the things that are in the middle of that and then find ways to cut some of those things on the outside so you're spending more and more time focused right